Productivity Hack Battle

Nick Doelman · Melissa Hale

Inclusion & Personal Development



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Introducing

SPEAKER



Nick Doelman

Microsoft MVP // ReadyBMS

I help companies build and adopt intelligent business solutions. Solution architect, trainer, content creator, and cohost of the Power Platform BOOST podcast.

Focus	Awards	Connect
Power Apps, Power Pages, Dataverse, Copilot Studio, AI	Microsoft MVP (8x), MCT, Canada Powerlifting	nickdoelman.com readyxrm.blog

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Introducing

SPEAKER



Melissa Hale

Power Platform Consultant // Kerv

Community Speaker, AI User Group Leader & Horse Archer.

Focus

Power Apps, Power Automate, Copilot Studio, AI Adoption & Accessibiliy

Awards

Microsoft MVP, WomenTech100 Winner, Community Rising Star

Connect

in/melissa-stephanie-hale/

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The format

PLAN

01 **Round 1 · Focus**

How we hold attention, and how we pick what to hold it on.

02 **Round 2 · Tasks and information**

Where the work lives, and how we find it again.

03 **Round 3 · AI tools**

What we actually hand to an agent, and what we keep.

04 **Vote after every round**

Scan the QR code, pick a side, done in five seconds.

05 **Steal everything**

Different brains, different jobs. Take whichever one fits yours.

Aims and Outcomes

Two hacks per round, one each, ninety seconds apiece. Every hack is one we use ourselves, built for busy and easily distracted brains. Nothing here is theory and nothing here is sponsored.

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Round 1: Focus

How we keep our focus, and what we are working on.

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The Pomodoro technique

Round 1 · Focus · Nick



One task. 25 minutes. Hard stop.

What: one timer, one task.

How: 25 on, 5 off. Timer sits on the phone.

Why: moving the timer breaks the reflex.

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The '20 – 5 – 3' Rule

Round 1 · Focus · Melissa

Why moving first works

65%
less tiredness after six weeks of 20-minute gentle workouts

383
studies pooled: one workout boosts focus, most of all straight after

50%
higher creativity scores after four days off-grid in nature

20-5-3: 20 minutes outside 3x a week, 5 hours a month, 3 days a year

Puetz, Flowers & O'Connor (2008), *Psychotherapy and Psychosomatics*; Chang et al. (2025), *Psychological Bulletin*; Atchley, Strayer & Atchley (2012), *PLOS ONE*; Michael Easter, *The Comfort Crisis* (2021).

Move first, think second!

What it is: movement is a natural stimulant

How to do it: take a 15 minute walk (outside) before you log in

Why it works: movement circulates blood (esp. to your brain)

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Round 1 vote

Scan to vote

Or type the link

- hum.vote/P8HC
- Which focus hack are you stealing?
- Scan, pick one, twenty seconds. One vote each, no campaigning.

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Round 2: Tasks and information

Where the work lives, and how we find it again.

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Double Time

Round 2 · Tasks and information · Melissa

Why double time works (and the catch)

62%
test score after watching at 2x, vs 65% at normal speed

2x
is the limit. At 2.5x, scores dropped to 55%

67%
of men chose an electric shock over sitting alone with their thoughts (women: 25%)

The rule: 2x what you have to watch. Then be bored with the time saved.

Murphy, Hoover, Agadzhanyan, Kuehn & Castel (2022), *Applied Cognitive Psychology*, 231 people; Wilson et al. (2014), *Science*; Michael Easter, *The Comfort Crisis* (2021).

Half the time, same result.

What it is: double the content, half the time

How to do it: set the video to 1.5 - 2x speed and hit play

Why it works: less mind wandering, more time efficient

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PARA, briefed for an agent

Round 2 · Tasks and information · Nick

P — Projects
A finish line and a date.

A — Areas
Ongoing. No end date.

R — Resources
Useful more than once.

A — Archive
Done or dormant. Kept.

```
ClaudeCoworkOS
├─ 01_Projects
│  └─ Community-Events
│     ├─ CLAUDE.md the brief
│     ├─ MEMORY.md the log
│     └─ Scottish-Summit-2026
│        ├─ CLAUDE.md
│        ├─ MEMORY.md
│        └─ HackBattle.pptx
├─ 02_Areas
├─ 03_Resources
└─ 04_Archive
```

Folders an agent can read.

What: PARA folders.

How: a CLAUDE.md brief and MEMORY.md log in each.

Why: the agent already knows the job.

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Round 2 vote

Scan to vote



Or type the link

- hum.vote/P8HC
- Which system would you actually keep?
- Scan, pick one, twenty seconds. One vote each, no campaigning.

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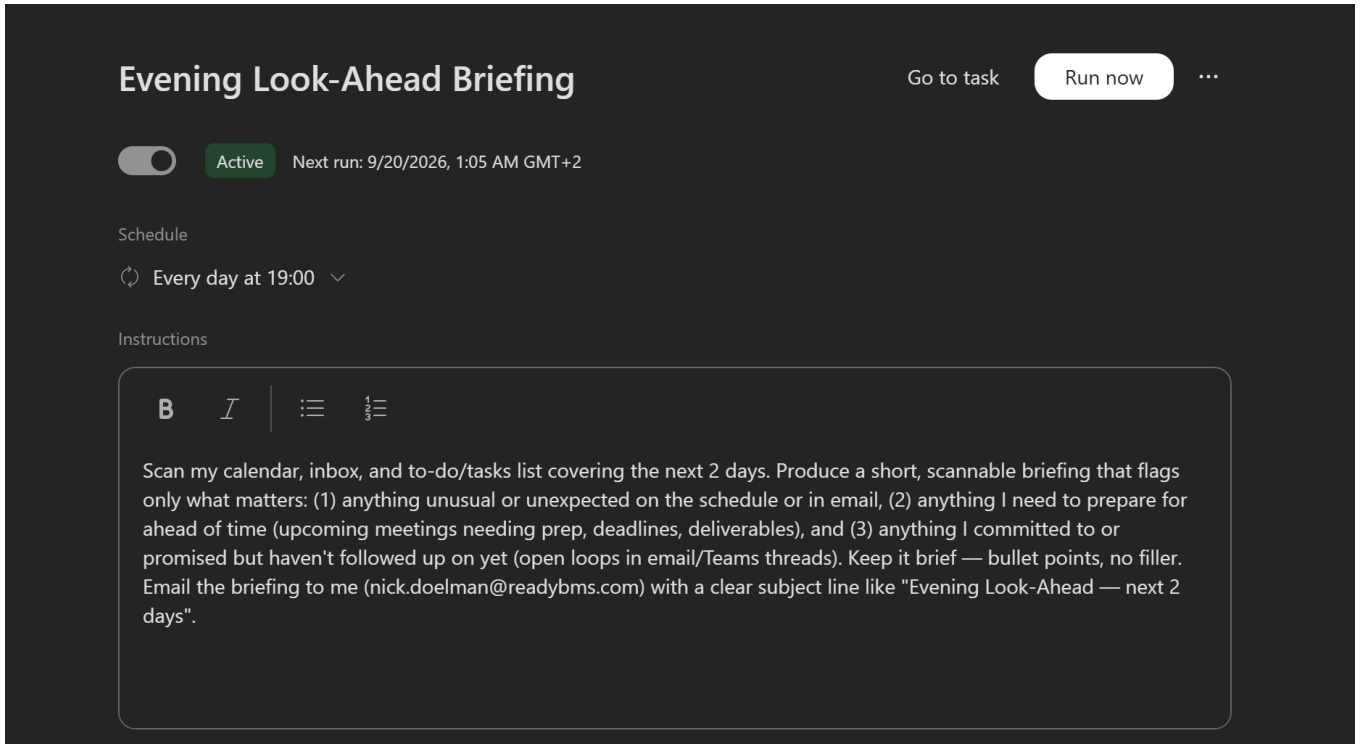
Round 3: AI tools

What we hand to an agent, and what we keep for ourselves.

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A nightly AI briefing

Round 3 · AI tools · Nick



Plan tomorrow tonight.

What: an agent emails me what matters.

How: one prompt, scheduled for 19:00.

Why: nothing slips through the cracks.

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Talk it out

Round 3 · AI tools · Melissa

Why talking it out works (and the catch)

3x

faster: 161 words a minute speaking vs 53 typing on a phone

+10.7%

more alike: what happened to stories written with AI ideas

81%+

of people had more creative ideas walking than sitting (up to 100% in one test)

The rule: AI tidies your words. It doesn't do your thinking.

Ruan et al. (2016), Stanford University; Doshi & Hauser (2024), *Science Advances*; Oppezzo & Schwartz (2014), *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition.*

Don't type it, say it.

What it is: AI dictation turns waffle into real value

How to do it: Wispr Flow, or Windows key + H into Copilot/ChatGPT/Claude input

Why it works: 3x faster than typing, no lost tangents

Round 3 vote

Scan to vote

Or type the link

- hum.vote/P8HC
- Which one earns its place in your week?
- Scan, pick one, twenty seconds. One vote each, no campaigning.

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And the winner is...

Tonight's belt



[Winner, filled in live]

The real winner: anyone still using one hack in March.

Tag #ScottishSummit with yours.

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Take one, not six

Pick the one that fits.

Set it up this week.

Drop what stops earning.

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Q&A and Feedback

Please submit your session and event feedback using the Scottish Summit App. Your feedback is super valuable and as an added motivator we have a prize draw for submissions.

Prizes include a Dynamics Minds conference ticket, a Game Console, Lego, and Scottish Summit Merch!

Prize draw will be held at the Cabaret with winners contacted after the event.

Feedback wins Prizes!

Session Feedback

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